

Jordan Walker

23.8 years old
Service Time: 2.044

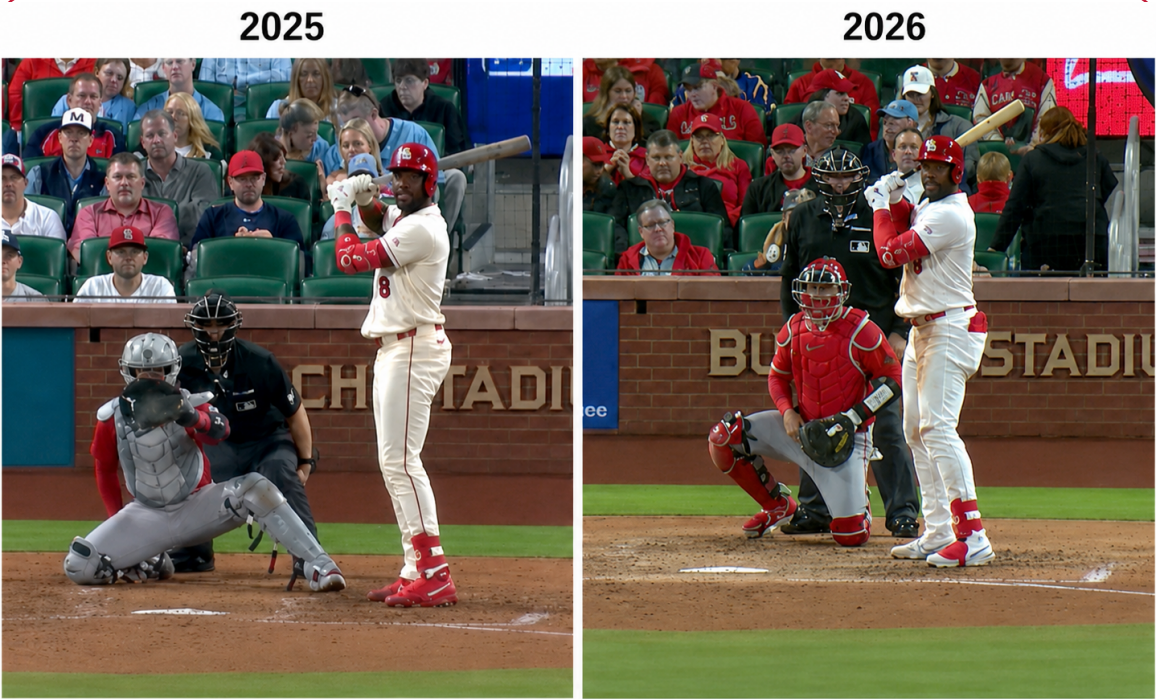
#18
Bats: Right
Throws: Right

G	AVG/OBP/SLG	HR	RBI	SB	BsR	wRC+	DRS	fWAR
142	.282/.338/.490	28	100	19	1.8	128	-6	3.0

A LATE BLOOMER BUILT ON INCREASING LIFT

Walker came into 2026 after a disappointing start to his career, but has shown true power potential to recapture his past projection. Between 2024 and 2025, Walker combined for -23.0 wRAA. So far in 2026, Walker has a 20.3 wRAA, completely transforming himself as a hitter. The main difference in his advanced stats is that Walker is barreling the ball more and leaning into his pull-side power. Walker's overall hard-hit% is down 1.4%, but he is finding the barrel at an even higher clip, going from 10.9% to 13.0%. Walker is also pulling the ball in the air more. His pull% is up 4.2% from 2025, his overall launch angle is up 1.8 degrees, and as a result, he has increased his HR/FB from 6.6% to 17.5%.

REBUILDING THE SETUP AND SEEING THE BALL DEEPER



Walker's pre-pitch stance and hand position, 2025 vs. 2026

Walker previously had an open stance and a narrow start, then incorporated a moderate leg lift. Walker also started with his hands closer to his head and had to load with a decent amount of movement before the pitch. Walker's hands are now placed farther from his head, reducing the need for the same-size load that could have led to more swing inconsistencies. In 2026, Walker reduced the size of his load, moved deeper in the box and further off the plate, closed his stance, and reduced the distance between his feet.

REBUILDING THE SETUP AND SEEING THE BALL DEEPER

In 2025, Walker saw 28.6% sliders and sweepers, and hit them for a combined run value of -7. On the 9.3% of changeups he saw, he had a -2 run value, and a whopping -6 run value of fastballs. In 2026, Walker had almost identical pitch usage numbers on his pitches, but has increased his run value on three different movement profiles: a 10-run increase on slider/sweepers, an 8-run increase on changeups and fastballs.

Walker is another bat-first power hitter with limited defensive range in the outfield. However, as a right fielder, Walker profiles well due to his plus arm strength (99th percentile). Walker's lack of range will need to be covered in right field. Walker has 2 OAA on balls he has to move back on, and -5 OAA/-4 OAA on balls where he has to move laterally to the left and right, respectively. Walker's limited range but strong arm could influence how the Cardinals construct and position their outfield in the future, especially if his continued power progression and arm strength outweigh his range limitations as the long-term option in RF.